

EdTech Student Portal

User Research, Persona Creation & Information

Architecture for a unified academic platform

serving college students.

User Research

Personas

Journey Mapping

Information Architecture

Prepared for: UI / UX Design & Systems Internship — RabTech Academy

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Problem Statement

The Problem

College students today rely on a scattered mix of tools and channels — college websites, notice boards, WhatsApp groups, email, and separate portals for attendance, results, and placements — to manage their academic life. There is no single, mobile-friendly place where a student can log in and get a complete picture of their courses, assignments, attendance, results, and career opportunities.

Target Users

- Undergraduate and postgraduate college students (18–24 years)
- Both first-year students still learning campus systems and final-year students preparing for placements
- Students with varying technical proficiency, primarily accessing the internet via smartphones

Current Difficulties Users Face

- Assignment deadlines and notices are shared inconsistently across email, WhatsApp, and notice boards, causing missed submissions.
- Attendance percentage is often checked only during exam-eligibility scares, since it isn't easy to track day-to-day.
- Results and grade information are delayed or split across multiple department-specific sheets/portals.
- Placement updates (eligibility, company visits, application deadlines) are shared informally and are easy to miss.
- Existing college portals are often outdated, desktop-only, and not designed for quick mobile checks between classes.

Why This Problem Needs to Be Solved

These gaps create real academic and career consequences: students lose marks for missed submissions, get blocked from exams due to unnoticed attendance shortfalls, and miss placement opportunities that directly affect their careers. A single, well-designed portal reduces this anxiety and administrative overhead for both students and college staff.

Proposed Solution

A unified, mobile-first **EdTech Student Portal** that consolidates courses, assignments, attendance, results, timetable, notifications, and placement information into one clean, easy-to-navigate dashboard — reducing the number of places a student has to check to stay on top of college life.

- First-year students need more guidance and simpler navigation than senior students.

Pain Points

PAIN POINT	IMPACT
Information scattered across channels	Missed deadlines and notices
No proactive attendance tracking	Exam-eligibility risk discovered too late
Desktop-only portals	Poor experience for mobile-first students
Informal placement communication	Missed application windows
Cluttered, dated interfaces	Low trust and engagement with existing tools

User Needs

- A single dashboard summarizing what needs attention today
- Real-time, proactive alerts for deadlines, attendance drops, and placement windows
- A mobile-first, lightweight experience
- Clear, simple navigation for less tech-savvy or newer students
- Quick access to results and course materials without hunting across menus

Design Opportunities

- Design a consolidated home dashboard with priority alerts at the top
- Introduce proactive push notifications for attendance and placement deadlines
- Build a simplified, card-based navigation suited to mobile-first use
- Create a dedicated placement hub combining eligibility, opportunities, and applications

SECTION 03

User Personas

Based on the research findings, two personas represent the primary user segments: a final-year student focused on placements and results, and a first-year student who needs simplicity and guidance.

Ananya Sharma

The Placement-Focused Senior — Primary Persona

Age	21
Education	Final Year, B.Com (Honours)
Background	Lives in a college hostel; balances coursework, exam prep, and an active placement search. Comfortable with apps but has little patience for clutter.
Technical Proficiency	High — uses multiple apps daily, expects modern, responsive design
Preferred Devices	Smartphone (primary), laptop (for applications and reports)

"I don't have time to check five different places just to find out if a company is visiting campus."

Goals

- Stay on top of placement opportunities and eligibility without missing deadlines
- Track final grades and attendance to ensure exam eligibility
- Manage coursework efficiently in her final semester

Needs

- A centralized placement hub with real-time updates
- Quick visibility into attendance percentage and results
- Reliable notifications she can trust, so she stops manually checking multiple sources

Pain Points

- Placement announcements shared informally and easy to miss
- No single view of eligibility criteria across companies
- Switching between apps wastes time during a busy final year

Behaviors & Motivations

Checks her phone frequently between classes; motivated by securing a good placement and finishing her degree with strong grades. Gets frustrated by systems that feel outdated or unreliable.

Frustrations

Feeling anxious about "missing something important" because information isn't centralized or proactively pushed to her.

Rohan Verma

The Overwhelmed First-Year — Secondary Persona

Age	18
Education	1st Year, B.Tech (Computer Science)
Background	Recently moved away from home for college; still learning how campus systems, timetables, and academic expectations work.
Technical Proficiency	Moderate — comfortable with everyday apps, but easily overwhelmed by complex or unfamiliar systems
Preferred Devices	Smartphone (almost exclusively)

"I didn't even know there was a portal for attendance until it was almost too late."

Goals

- Understand what's expected of him each week (classes, assignments, attendance rules)
- Avoid falling behind without realizing it
- Build confidence navigating college systems independently

Needs

- Simple, guided navigation with minimal jargon
- Clear alerts before problems occur (e.g., attendance dropping close to the limit)
- An easy way to find study materials and course details

Pain Points

- Unaware of tools and portals that already exist
- Finds dense, text-heavy interfaces confusing
- Anxious about missing deadlines due to unfamiliarity with the system

Behaviors & Motivations

Relies heavily on friends and seniors for information; motivated to settle into college life and avoid academic trouble in his first year.

Frustrations

Feeling like important information is "hidden" and only discovered by accident or too late.

User Journey Map

Journey mapped for the primary persona, **Ananya Sharma**, during a typical week of checking her academic and placement status.

STAGE	USER ACTIONS	TOUCHPOINTS	THOUGHTS	EMOTION	PAIN POINTS / OPPORTUNITIES
1. Discover / Login	Opens the app, logs in with college credentials	Login screen, biometric/OTP	"I hope this loads fast, I only have 5 minutes."	😐 Neutral	Slow login discourages frequent checks → enable biometric login and persistent sessions
2. Explore Dashboard	Scans homepage for anything urgent	Home dashboard, notification bell	"Is there anything I'm missing today?"	😏 Curious	Opportunity to surface a "Today" summary card with top 3 priorities
3. Check Courses / Assignments	Opens Assignments tab to check pending submissions	Courses, Assignments list	"Did I submit the marketing case study yet?"	😬 Slightly anxious	Pain point: unclear submission status → add clear "Submitted / Pending / Graded" tags
4. Track Attendance	Checks attendance percentage per subject	Attendance screen	"Am I still above 75%?"	😬 Worried	Opportunity: visual progress bar with alerts before falling below threshold
5. Check Results / Progress	Reviews latest test/exam results	Results screen	"Let's see how I did on the internal exam."	😬 Nervous → 😊 Relieved	Pain point: delayed result updates → push notification the moment results are published
6. Complete Required Action	Applies to a placement opportunity flagged as eligible	Placement hub, Application form	"I don't want to miss this deadline."	😊 Confident	Opportunity: one-tap apply with pre-filled profile data to reduce friction

Emotional Curve

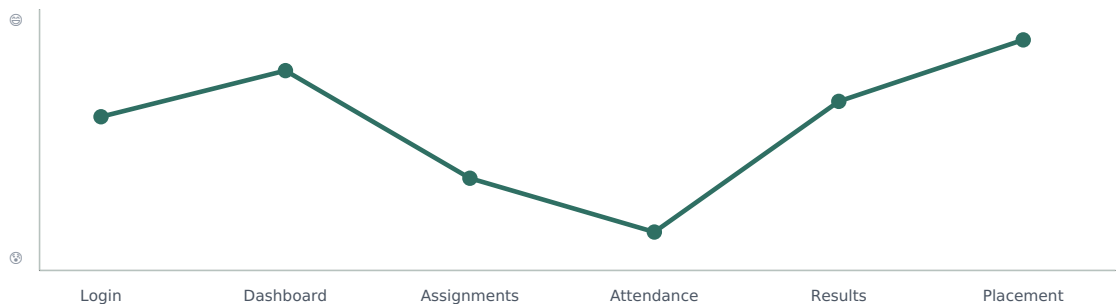
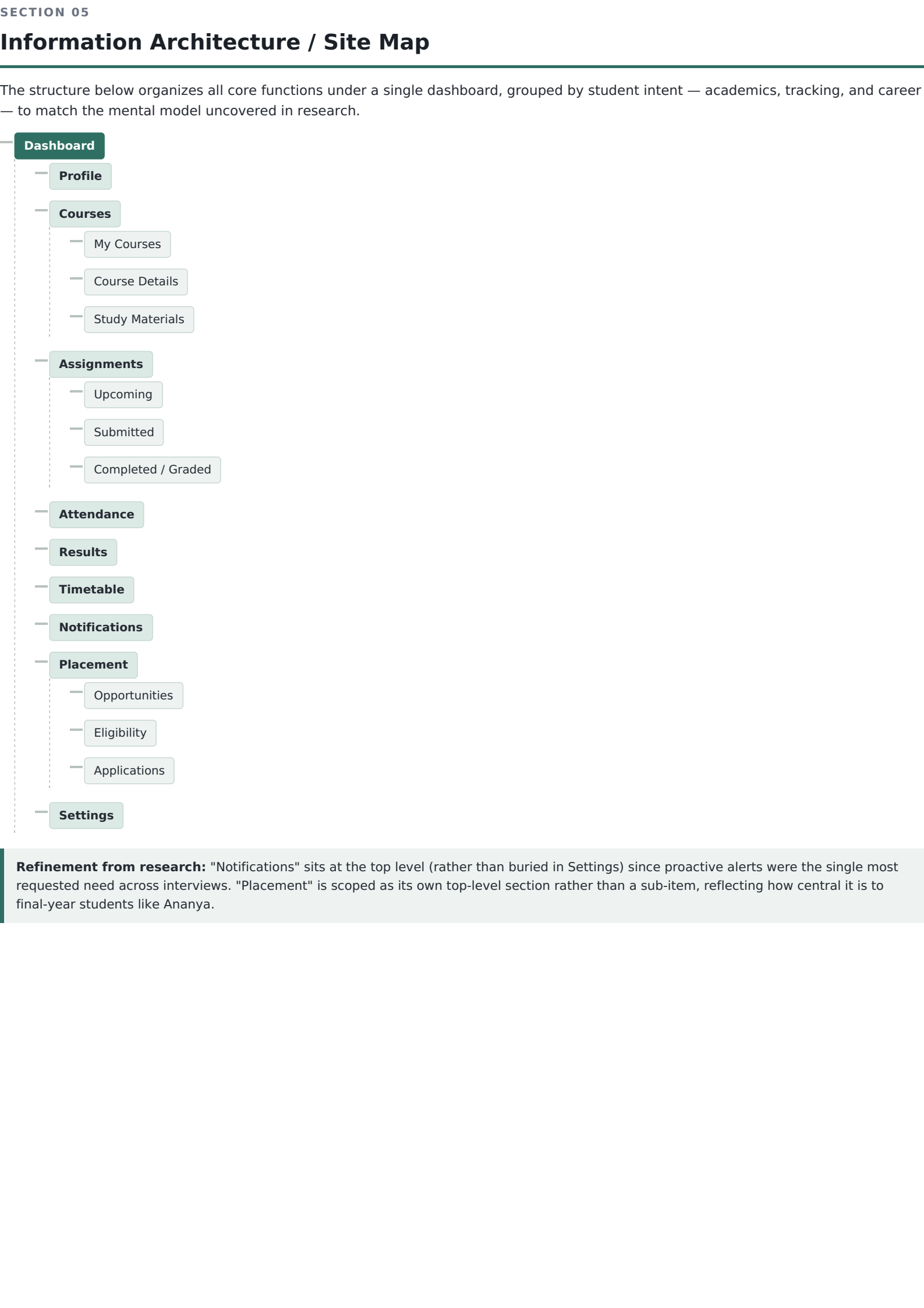
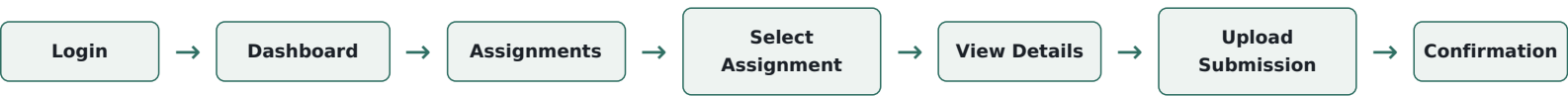


Figure: Emotional curve dips at Assignments and Attendance (uncertainty) and rises through Results and Placement once clarity and progress are confirmed.



User Flow — Assignment Submission

This flow illustrates how a student submits an assignment from login to confirmation, a task directly tied to one of the most common pain points identified in research.



Step-by-Step Explanation

1. **Login:** Student authenticates using college ID/OTP or biometric login for faster repeat access.
2. **Dashboard:** Lands on the home screen, which surfaces a "Due Soon" card highlighting pending assignments.
3. **Assignments:** Taps into the Assignments section, defaulting to the "Upcoming" tab so pending work is visible first.
4. **Select Assignment:** Chooses the relevant assignment from a list showing course name, due date, and status.
5. **View Details:** Reviews assignment instructions, attached materials, and the submission deadline/countdown.
6. **Upload Submission:** Attaches a file (PDF/doc) or enters a text response, with a progress indicator during upload.
7. **Confirmation:** Receives an on-screen success message and a confirmation notification, with the assignment status updating to "Submitted."

Design Opportunities — Summary

- **Unified "Today" dashboard** surfacing the most urgent items (deadlines, attendance alerts, placement windows) in one glance.
- **Proactive notifications** for attendance dropping near the eligibility threshold and new placement opportunities.
- **Mobile-first, card-based navigation** to match how students actually access information — in short sessions between classes.
- **Dedicated Placement hub** consolidating opportunities, eligibility, and applications to remove reliance on informal channels.
- **Simplified onboarding** for first-year students to build awareness of features that exist but are currently undiscovered.
- **Clear status tagging** (Pending / Submitted / Graded) across assignments to remove ambiguity.

Final Summary

This case study walked through the early UX process for the EdTech Student Portal — starting from a clear problem statement, grounded in sample research that surfaced real, relatable pain points around scattered information, reactive attendance tracking, and informal placement communication. Two personas, Ananya and Rohan, represent the core user segments the portal must serve: the placement-focused senior and the guidance-seeking first-year student. Mapping Ananya's journey revealed where anxiety peaks (assignments, attendance) and where confidence returns (results, placement action), directly informing the proposed information architecture and the assignment-submission user flow. Together, these artifacts form a research-backed foundation for designing a single, trustworthy home for a student's academic life.

This document was prepared as a UI/UX internship assessment deliverable. All research data is sample/assumption-based and created for demonstration purposes; no real students were interviewed.